

Methanol

China April Import/Export Prices Higher

2026 Extel
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China imported 563kt of methanol in April 2026, (29%) lower y/y compared to 788kt in April 2025 but 29% higher sequentially versus 438kt in March 2026. Import volumes year to date totaled 2,969kt and were 4% higher compared to the same period in 2025. Import prices lifted by 32% sequentially from \$277/t in March to \$365/t in April 2026 and were 22% higher y/y. The average import price in 2025 was \$279/t.

China exported 173kt of methanol in April 2026, a jump compared to 66kt in March 2026 and 54kt in April 2025. Export prices lifted 25% sequentially to \$483/t in April 2026. Export prices were 37% higher y/y compared to \$354/t in April 2025.

Figure 1: China Methanol Imports

in 000 mt

Imports	2018	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025	2026
January	797.2	887.5	1,048.2	853.7	954.0	900.0	1,383.2	1,042.3	1,083.9
February	597.3	728.1	673.5	793.1	674.5	1,020.3	892.7	561.8	884.7
March	730.1	672.5	845.6	968.3	967.4	1,133.3	810.5	473.0	437.9
April	602.8	632.9	1,073.8	1,009.0	1,141.6	906.0	1,095.2	787.7	562.7
May	521.7	819.9	1,059.5	1,087.9	1,199.2	1,377.6	1,063.6	1,292.3	
June	459.1	907.3	1,274.3	1,122.9	1,070.4	1,363.7	1,057.3	1,220.2	
July	504.8	972.6	1,362.6	885.7	1,251.8	1,250.4	1,290.2	1,102.7	
August	714.6	1,073.1	975.0	1,019.9	1,056.2	1,281.9	1,221.4	1,759.8	
September	537.7	966.7	1,241.7	876.3	984.2	1,333.2	1,248.7	1,426.9	
October	665.5	1,120.4	1,177.6	852.8	1,021.5	1,305.8	1,217.1	1,612.6	
November	580.5	920.9	1,106.7	1,053.4	904.6	1,397.1	1,085.1	1,392.1	
December	717.2	1,193.1	1,106.3	675.0	967.3	1,283.5	1,119.1	1,734.0	
Total	7,428.6	10,895.0	12,944.8	11,198.0	12,193.0	14,552.9	13,484.2	14,405.4	2,969.2
% change		46.7%	18.8%	-13.5%	8.9%	19.4%	-7.3%	6.8%	3.6%

Source: China General Administration of Customs. Note: Data in the table does not precisely match calculations due to rounding.

Figure 2: China Methanol Exports

in 000 mt

Exports	2018	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025	2026
January	1.2	69.3	0.8	36.7	14.2	0.5	7.6	32.5	30.9
February	7.7	9.8	12.3	5.7	12.3	8.5	3.1	10.1	15.2
March	9.0	11.8	11.9	64.9	18.1	5.5	0.3	12.4	65.7
April	9.8	25.1	18.8	77.7	8.8	1.1	0.3	54.4	173.0
May	41.9	12.6	0.3	39.6	26.4	18.0	11.2	15.3	
June	5.5	8.7	3.7	10.5	20.1	29.6	0.2	17.5	
July	9.6	13.1	1.0	22.8	23.7	3.4	15.8	10.7	
August	44.9	1.2	11.5	24.1	0.5	5.6	22.4	19.9	
September	67.6	14.9	0.8	64.5	31.7	6.3	25.8	17.7	
October	20.2	0.7	7.1	24.3	12.8	8.2	6.1	27.0	
November	50.1	2.6	17.4	2.2	3.9	35.5	59.1	32.6	
December	48.6	1.2	35.7	20.0	0.2	26.9	5.3	42.3	
Total	316.4	171.0	121.2	392.8	172.8	149.2	157.2	292.5	284.8
% change		-46.0%	-29.1%	224.1%	-56.0%	-13.7%	5.4%	86.0%	160.4%

Source: China General Administration of Customs. Note: Data in the table does not precisely match calculations due to rounding.

Figure 3: China Methanol Import/Export Pricing

in \$/mt

	Import	M/M % chg	Y/Y % chg	Export	M/M %	Y/Y % chg
Jan-22	361	-7.3%	16.1%	382	-6.2%	19.1%
Feb-22	355	-1.5%	9.4%	360	-5.6%	5.5%
Mar-22	371	4.4%	16.3%	418	16.1%	19.7%
Apr-22	397	7.0%	25.9%	447	6.9%	29.7%
May-22	374	-5.7%	17.0%	423	-5.5%	24.5%
Jun-22	355	-5.2%	5.7%	362	-14.4%	5.0%
Jul-22	329	-7.3%	-1.7%	376	3.8%	10.7%
Aug-22	302	-8.3%	-10.6%	530	41.1%	39.7%
Sep-22	303	0.4%	-12.9%	315	-40.6%	-11.3%
Oct-22	313	3.5%	-16.8%	369	17.2%	-3.5%
Nov-22	321	2.4%	-26.3%	364	-1.3%	-12.7%
Dec-22	314	-2.3%	-19.4%	497	36.7%	22.2%
Jan-23	309	-1.6%	-14.4%	439	-11.8%	14.9%
Feb-23	317	2.7%	-10.7%	389	-11.3%	8.0%
Mar-23	327	3.1%	-11.8%	377	-3.2%	-10.0%
Apr-23	315	-3.8%	-20.7%	504	33.8%	12.7%
May-23	296	-6.0%	-21.0%	322	-36.1%	-23.8%
Jun-23	265	-10.4%	-25.3%	290	-9.9%	-19.9%
Jul-23	249	-6.0%	-24.3%	268	-7.6%	-28.7%
Aug-23	258	3.7%	-14.4%	332	23.9%	-37.3%
Sep-23	276	6.8%	-8.9%	302	-9.1%	-4.0%
Oct-23	284	3.2%	-9.2%	416	37.9%	12.9%
Nov-23	283	-0.3%	-11.7%	331	-20.4%	-8.9%
Dec-23	288	1.4%	-8.3%	312	-6.0%	-37.4%
Jan-24	289	0.5%	-6.3%	318	2.2%	-27.5%
Feb-24	288	-0.3%	-9.1%	330	3.7%	-15.2%
Mar-24	300	4.2%	-8.1%	535	62.1%	42.1%
Apr-24	304	1.3%	-3.3%	776	45.1%	54.1%
May-24	302	-0.7%	2.2%	349	-55.1%	8.4%
Jun-24	305	0.9%	15.0%	885	153.6%	205.0%
Jul-24	299	-1.8%	20.2%	311	-64.8%	16.2%
Aug-24	293	-2.2%	13.3%	332	6.5%	-0.1%
Sep-24	290	-0.9%	5.1%	310	-6.5%	2.7%
Oct-24	291	0.6%	2.5%	327	5.4%	-21.5%
Nov-24	293	0.6%	3.5%	327	0.1%	-1.2%
Dec-24	297	1.3%	3.3%	328	0.3%	5.4%
Jan-25	303	2.0%	4.7%	297	-9.6%	-6.7%
Feb-25	307	1.2%	6.4%	373	25.6%	13.0%
Mar-25	307	0.0%	2.1%	301	-19.3%	-43.8%
Apr-25	300	-2.2%	-1.5%	354	17.6%	-54.4%
May-25	272	-9.3%	-10.0%	319	-9.8%	-8.5%
Jun-25	266	-2.1%	-12.6%	468	46.6%	-47.1%
Jul-25	279	4.9%	-6.7%	683	46.0%	119.4%
Aug-25	277	-0.7%	-5.2%	358	-47.6%	7.9%
Sep-25	271	-2.3%	-6.5%	326	-9.0%	5.0%
Oct-25	264	-2.4%	-9.3%	352	8.1%	7.7%
Nov-25	259	-1.9%	-11.6%	289	-17.8%	-11.6%
Dec-25	241	-7.2%	-19.0%	267	-7.8%	-18.7%
Jan-26	248	3.0%	-18.2%	279	4.5%	-6.0%
Feb-26	266	7.2%	-13.4%	366	31.1%	-1.9%
Mar-26	277	4.4%	-9.6%	386	5.4%	28.1%
Apr-26	365	31.8%	21.9%	483	25.3%	36.5%

Source: China General Administration of Customs.

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